Graduate School Request for Leave of Absence

Virginia Tech -- The Graduate School -- Request for Leave of Absence

Student information

Field	Entry
Name	David Barron
Student ID	9061-XXXXX (redacted in this copy)
Degree / program	PhD, Computer Science
Department	Computer Science
Advisor	Dr. Yan Chen
VT email	dbarron410@vt.edu

Leave requested

Field	Entry
First term of leave	Fall 2026
Expected return term	Fall 2027
Reason	Professional / entrepreneurial (co-founding a company related to research area)
Assistantship ends	August 15, 2026

Student statement

I am requesting a leave of absence beginning Fall 2026 to co-found Mathetic, a public benefit corporation building research tools closely related to my dissertation area. I will complete my outstanding UIST 2026 camera-ready and conference presentation obligations, which concern work done while enrolled. I understand that I will not be enrolled during the leave, that my graduate assistantship ends on August 15, 2026, and that I must notify the Graduate School before my expected return term.

Signatures

Role	Name	Date
Student	David Barron (signed)	07/27/2026
Advisor	Yan Chen (signed)	07/29/2026
Graduate program director	(signed)	07/30/2026
Graduate program coordinator	Grace Kim (processed)	07/31/2026

Processing note: approved effective Fall 2026. Time-to-degree clock extended by the length of the approved leave. University email and storage access remain active during an approved leave.